A world with a history

Established humans at the start. Changing opportunities, cultures and populations afterward.

The starting point

World Year 0 represents established **Homo sapiens** around the equivalent of 200,000 years ago. Other hominin lineages have their own connected ancestral dispersal, isolation, physical traits and ancestry. There are no invented states or universal calendar-based technology unlocks.

What the model tracks

Climate and ecology	Stable ecological boundaries; changing temperature, rain, ice, vegetation potential and local species presence. Wet corridors, refugia and real shelf depths affect movement.
People and resources	Age structure, births, deaths, food, winter protection, mating contacts and local shocks. Populations can retreat or disappear. Splitting a population record creates no extra food access.
Technology	43 techniques with separate familiarity, trained prevalence and actual use. Prerequisites, materials, teachers, innovation and forgetting matter. Useful technologies spread through real contact.
Language	Inherited words and grammar change at different rates. Borrowing, bilingual contact, local varieties and recognisable families are separate from deep common ancestry.
Culture and belief	Distinct social norms, exchange relationships and residence patterns. Local rites, sacred places/animals, mortuary practices and spiritual themes vary and spread without churches or states.
Human lineages	Different body/face profiles, cultural capacities, geographic histories and mixed ancestry. Competition and survival depend on actual conditions; extinction is not scheduled by date.
Local inhabitants	Stable bands, households, birthdays, parents, seasonal camps and contacts. Samples contain actual proficient makers, individual language knowledge and separate routine/winter equipment.

How this reaches the game

The simulation produces local evidence for the next supervised NPC implementation.

From a district to a camp

A local query supplies a band, related people, appearance, spoken languages, capable craft specialists, equipment practices and a seasonal itinerary. The NPC host must retain instantiated people and player edits. Camp candidates still need physical ground, water and collision validation.

Observe the actual differences

Language/family, cultural identity, spiritual tradition, toolkit and human-species layers read different data. Political territories remain empty. Climate/ecology maps follow the dated world. Technology inspection distinguishes knowing a method, being able to make it and routinely using it.

World continuity and performance

Small demographic reviews and slower network/ecology reviews share one saved timeline. Long histories remain computationally expensive. Nearby queries use district/contact indexes. Terrain workers read the exact planet without duplicating the population archive; dated local-map colours stay with the player.

Generate a new world for this revision

New worlds use **foragers-4**: additive resource claims and teaching from actual capable makers. Rare experts are distinct from population-wide adoption. Existing saves retain their older model. Compact saves preserve historical fields; earlier formats stay readable. Git and asset packs provide rollback.

Validation and scope

Check several seeds and dates, expansion and retreat, local technique differences, real vocabulary divergence, household consistency, save/reload, live map playback and entering gameplay. Physical NPC camps/dialogue, new hominin art, moving shorelines/ice-sheet terrain and post-Paleolithic progression are separate implementation stages.

Selected research behind the mechanisms

Structured African ancestry and connected populations

Climate, habitats and hominin distributions

Forager networks and cumulative culture

Language change: unequal rates across features

Forager belief systems and their variation

Culture-linked competition and assimilation